

Asia Tech Tour

Key takeaways

We concluded J.P. Morgan's 11th Asia Tech Tour last week, meeting 37 companies with 115 investors in attendance. The overall message from companies remains constructive. Demand appears to be very strong across the GPU and ASIC foodchain, and while non-AI demand (industrial, automotive) is also showing some recovery, PC demand appears more resilient than feared, with smartphones being the only area of weakness. Within AI, demand appears to be broadening out, with Neoclouds (including SpaceX) now representing a new vector of compute demand, in addition to strong buying intent from CSPs. Supply remains tight across the foodchain, with key bottlenecks being lead edge foundry, advanced packaging, substrates and, increasingly, PCBs. Memory demand appears to remain strong despite concerns around despeccing and Memory makers (SEC, SKH, Kioxia, NYT) delivered positive messaging on elongated tightness, keeping prices elevated and LTAs smoothening out the cyclicalities. The supply response is starting to come through across the foodchain, with incumbents (TSMC, memory, OSAT, substrate vendors) and newcomers (tier-2 foundries, smaller memory players, Chinese memory vendors and peripheral OSATs) stepping up their capex spending in 2026, with continued growth into 2027. Bottlenecks are now shifting to clean-room capacity and, soon, to lengthening equipment delivery lead times. Clear positive narratives from the Tour were TSMC, ASE, ASPEED, Unimicron, EMC, Hon Precision, Hon Hai, while ASIC vendors (Mediatek, Alchip, GUC) remain contentious due to increased competitive concerns (we are OW on all three with Mediatek and Alchip being our top picks) and investor appetite for high-beta commodity sectors (wafers, MLCC) remains muted. Within Asia Tech, we remain positive on SPE names (Hon. Precision, Advantest, Chroma, Tokyo Electron) due to increasing confidence in WPE spending, advanced packaging supply chain (ASE, ASMPT, GPTC, All Ring), IC Substrates (Unimicron) and companies with higher exposure to the optical/NPO foodchain (Chroma, Hon. Precision). Memory remains a contentious area, given ongoing discussion of despeccing with some discussion in the Asia server foodchain of AI Labs even exploring 4Hi HBM designs for future ASIC/GPU configurations.

- Leading-edge foundry demand strong; price hikes coming through in 8" and parts of mature 12":** Leading-edge demand remains robust, with TSMC building 13 fabs in Taiwan. The capacity planning is informed by direct engagement with both customers and customers' customers on end demand, while also factoring power supply and datacenter construction into the capex decisions. Although Intel competition remains a key investor focus, we believe Intel may secure some project wins in packaging (e.g. EMIB-T for TPU v9); however, at the front end we still do not see any major project wins, given the technology lag (Intel 18A is comparable to TSMC N3E, and by the time Intel 14A enters mass production in 2028, we expect the TSMC N2 family to already be approaching a \$50–60bn revenue run rate) and the typical 3–5year engagement cycle from initial design to mass production. On the mature-node side, demand appears very strong only in selective areas—e.g. Power management, analog, and MCU—while consumer-electronics-related demand remains lackluster, a dynamic we expect to persist into 2027 as we do not anticipate a strong recovery in the CE end market. Consequently, price hikes are concentrated primarily in 8", with VIS confirming another round of price-hike negotiations currently underway and likely a further round in early

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2027, following the one already completed in 1H26. Capacity wise, we expect industry capacity to remain largely flat in the coming years, given limited industry capacity expansion, while equipment for any TSMC ramp down will likely be sold to other foundries—likely VIS. By contrast, 12" mature nodes continue to see new capacity coming online—including VSMC, UMC SG 12i P4 and Tainan 12A P7/P8, and China-based foundries—which, combined with weak CE demand, leads us to expect price hikes to be confined to selectively tighter nodes, such as 40nm and 65nm. We prefer TSMC for leading edge exposure and mature foundries with less CE exposure, such as VIS and PSMC. *(Hariharan)*

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- **OSAT supply tightness intensifying; clean-room and equipment key bottleneck:** We believe OSAT capacity tightness is intensifying, with the bottleneck shifting from clean room availability toward increasingly prolonged equipment lead times. Advanced packaging equipment is emerging as a key bottleneck, particularly for CoW tools (lead times up to 12 months), as traditional OSATs and TSMC compete for the same tool set. Major Asian OSATs have raised their capex budgets to record highs in 2026 (up 80%+ YoY), on the back of robust advanced packaging demand and tight facility availability. While OSATs are actively acquiring brownfield sites to shorten conversion time (greenfield build takes ~2 years), lead times still run at least 6–9 months. We therefore expect OSAT capacity tightness to extend at least into 2027/28, with capex staying elevated over the next few years. Overall, we maintain our positive view on the advanced packaging supply chain, namely ASE, ASMPT and GPTC. *(Hariharan)*
- **Strong ASIC demand, but confusion reigns on vendor selection, especially for TPUs:** ASIC demand remains strong, supported by fast-growing unit volumes and specification upgrades, which is driving very strong ASP growth from generation to generation. We expect all major Taiwan design-service names to grow strongly in 2026-28, each with its own narrative—Alchip on Trainium 3/4, MediaTek on Google TPU v8/v9, and GUC on Google Axion CPU. However, as scale rises, large CSPs are increasingly trending toward a CoT business model over the long term, while engaging different design-service vendors for different components or SKUs (e.g., CPU, GPU, and SRAM-based chips). The debate over TPU v10 is particularly pronounced at present, with most design-service providers still in the bidding stage and multiple business models under discussion. We continue to believe MediaTek will be the primary design partner, responsible for the packaging design and integration, though it is possible that Alchip or GUC could take a small portion of the business (e.g., TK2 or TK3 for the compute die); on this basis, we expect MediaTek to still enjoy a decent ASP uptick from v9 to v10. While v10 revenue is unlikely to contribute before 2029, the surrounding narrative has been capping the incumbent vendor's (MediaTek) share-price momentum. We expect a decision in the coming months and anticipate that the outcome will resolve this overhang and resume Mediatek's stock outperformance. *(Hariharan)*
- **Server demand still strong; supply constraints linger:** We continue to see strong demand signals across the supply chain, with order visibility extending into 2027 and initial order discussions for 2028. EMC raised its 3Q26 revenue outlook to ~20% QoQ growth, up from ~15% previously. Lotes and Chenbro both indicate 30%+ server revenue growth next year, while ASPEED points to high-single-digit / 50%+ shipment growth for general-purpose/agent-AI servers, respectively, next year. That said, component shortages remain the key bottleneck — primarily memory, CCLs/PCBs, and MLCCs — which is supportive of pricing dynamics. ASPEED plans to raise prices in 4Q26, with potential further hikes next year to pass through incremental costs. In addition, our research points to a rising mix of Neocloud/enterprise demand next year; given their larger scale, some Neoclouds/enterprises have approached server ODMs (e.g., Hon Hai, Quanta) for customization and cost savings. Within the server space, we prefer server component vendors (e.g., ASPEED, EMC, Unimicron, Tripod), while remaining selective on server ODMs (OWs: Wiwynn, Hon Hai, Wistron). *(Hung)*

- **ASICs becoming the major liquid cooling contributor from 2027, driving further GM expansion:** The liquid cooling companies are seeing resuming momentum in 2H26, driven by the mass production of Nvidia VR200 and some CSP ASIC projects (e.g. AWS Trainium 3 and Google TPU v8). Looking forward, the leading players in the market (such as AVC, Jentech) will continue to benefit from increasing liquid cooling content in future generations given further spec upgrades and more complicated system design. Meanwhile, ASICs will become a bigger liquid cooling revenue driver from 2027, thanks to their rapidly rising liquid cooling penetration and higher content value. Also, coupled with a more consolidated supplier landscape for each CSP ASIC project (generally 2 major suppliers + 1-2 smaller back-up ones), the qualified suppliers can also enjoy higher margins, which should drive continued GM and earnings expansion in 2H26 and onwards. *(Yang, Hsueh)*
- **Substrate value-add rapidly increasing; more AI PCB adopting HDI:** As high-end substrate supply tightness continues, Unimicron (3037 TT, covered by Jerry Tsai) noted that LTA terms continue to favor substrate makers as they lock only volume delivery and not the pricing. Meanwhile, substrate pricing (negotiated by chip generation) is also favorable as it tends to guarantee attractive margins (say, 50%-60%) these days even after taking substrate fabrication yield into account. On the high-profile EMIB-T substrate, Unimicron highlighted that EMIB-T substrate is more complex vs CoWoS as the workload of IC package is increasingly reliant on substrate in the absence of interposer. It also mentioned that there are three substrate makers involved, while satisfying yields are still a work in progress. With larger chip designs and higher TDP, we believe the substrate's increasingly important role continues to favor leaders such as Unimicron. On the CCL/PCB front, EMC management agreed that there's upside risk to the market's near-term revenue expectations. It also re-iterated that it is on track to add 40-50%/70-80% capacity by YE2027/YE2028. As one of the few players capable of producing high-end CCL (say, M8 and above), EMC noted that this aggressive expansion plan should lead to visible market share gain in key AI projects. Meanwhile, component supply shortage, especially glass fiber (for low-end CCL) and copper foil (for high-end CCL), continues to drive component price hike for CCL players. However, we expect both high-end CCL and PCB makers' margins to be largely stable as both can pass through cost inflation to clients. On the PCB front, more and more AI PCB projects are expected to adopt HDI technology in the future – in addition to Nvidia, we expect Google's AI projects to start adopting HDI in 2H27 (some shipments will start in 4Q26 for qualification purposes). *(Tsai)*
- **MLCC price hikes more disciplined vs. last cycle, but long-term trend constructive:** On the MLCC front, YAGEO noted that it continues to see healthy demand from both AI, while also benefiting from mid-range IT (non-AI) MLCC overflow from North Asian MLCC peers. It re-iterated that AI is a structural long-term demand driver for the passive component industry and it is still early in the cycle (2nd inning if we use baseball analogy). While some investors expect very aggressive pricing action from the MLCC industry, YAGEO believes MLCC vendors are more disciplined this cycle to prioritize long-term relationships with customers, which confirms their belief of the durability of this cycle. We reiterate our positive view on the passive component industry. *(Tsai)*
- **Little doubt on memory fundamentals; shareholder return policies under scrutiny:** We believe constructive mid-to-long term memory fundamentals are widely accepted among investors, but memory share price outlooks were put to question due to shareholder returns, memory content-cuts, and skepticism on LTA ([report](#)). Notably, shareholder returns were the key investor debate topic, and we sense investors perceive SKH's policy to lift the shareholder return pool from <50% to >50% as a relative positive vs. SEC's W30trn dividend buyback and W90-W110trn shareholder returns. Memory content cuts were caused by insufficient memory supply more so than performance downgrade intent, and we believe memory makers' tight HBM market guidance and

Agentic AI CPU demand strength poses an upside risk to our HBM ASP (JPME: +43% y-y in 27E) and server content growth assumptions (blended server content growth +28% y-y in 27E). We believe NAND is tracking better than our expectations, supported by KV cache offloading demand (TLC NAND as the primary solution) but also multiple emerging solutions being discussed including SLC NAND, super high IOPS, and Z-NAND. (*Kwon*)

- **Weakening PC end demand; likely better-than-feared margins at leading PC brands:** We see weakening PC end demand in 2H26, with desktops softer than laptops and the commercial segment more resilient than consumer. Lotes noted that PC ODM forecasts point to sub-seasonal DT/NB shipment trends in 3Q26 (HSD decline / flattish QoQ, respectively). We attribute the demand weakness to memory-led price elasticity and key component shortages. We attribute the gap between the HSD-to-low-teens% ODM shipment decline and the flattish-to-up QoQ PC sell-in outlook to memory-led inventory pre-building in 1H. In addition, we expect better-than-feared margins for leading PC brands (e.g., Lenovo, ASUSTek), supported by favorable supply agreements and product-mix adjustments. In the PC space, our pecking order is Lenovo > ASUSTek > MSI > Compal. (*Hung*)
- **Raw Wafers at an inflection point but mind the expectation gap:** Both GlobalWafers (GWC) and Wafer Works (WW; 6182 TT, Non-Covered) believe the silicon wafer industry is at an inflection point, as customer inventories are improving and silicon wafer pricing is (or about to be) on an uptrend. GWC indicated that 12" spot prices are improving and will be slightly higher than 12" LTA prices in 4Q26. Micro's LTA will start in 2027, and more customers are negotiating for new LTAs. GWC expects 2H26 GM to be similar to the 1H26 level but GM to be much better in 2027. GWC reiterated that 2026 revenue to be flat or up slightly YoY, as Italy site fire incident in late Jul impact its 8" shipments in 2H26 (8" 25% of GWC's revenue & Italy site 30% of 8" GWC's capacity -> 7.5% of total revenue). Wafer Works indicated it has hiked 6" prices by 10% in 2H26 and it could hike 8" prices by 10% to partial customers by end 2026. Both GWC and WW are developing products for advanced packaging and view it as a potential driver from 2028. GWC provides SiC carriers and square silicon substrates, while WW provides square silicon substrates and dummy dies. In our view, the pricing upward magnitude and schedule remain key watch points. As the silicon wafer stocks have rallied on high expectations, how the pricing benefits compare to the bullish expectations will be a more critical factor than the new pricing itself. (*Huang*)

Table 1: Top stock picks - Valuation

Company	Ticker	Price (LC)	Price target (LC)	Mkt. cap (\$ mn)	Rating	Return 2026	PE		PB		ROE (%)		Dividend yield (%)	Price upside (%)
							FY26E	FY27E	FY26E	FY27E	FY26E	FY27E		
TSMC	2330 TT	2,375	3,200	1,912,700	OW	50%	22.0	16.8	8.0	5.9	42.7%	40.3%	1.2%	35%
ASE	3711 TT	592	700	80,681	OW	129%	29.0	18.6	6.4	5.2	24%	31%	1.1%	18%
Unimicron	3037 TT	1,075	1,225	52,612	OW	391%	55.5	24.2	12.6	9.1	26%	44%	0.2%	14%
EMC	2383 TT	5,430	7,200	60,281	OW	242%	48.2	25.3	26.5	15.4	65%	77%	0.5%	33%
Aspeed	5274 TT	15,115	23,000	19,381	OW	129%	69.7	41.4	42.6	27.4	78%	81%	0.5%	52%
Accton	2345 TT	2,070	3,700	35,476	OW	81%	22.9	17.3	13.2	8.9	70%	62%	0.7%	79%
Wistron	6669 TT	6,300	7,500	35,872	OW	41%	18.3	14.4	5.3	4.2	35%	33%	2.3%	19%
AVC	3017 TT	2,855	4,000	33,943	OW	96%	26.7	17.5	14.3	9.0	65%	63%	0.7%	40%
Hon. Precision	7769 TT	6,255	8,350	34,861	OW	82%	48.7	28.5	15.4	11.6	35%	46%	N/A	33%
SEC	005930 KS	256,000	400,000	1,052,900	OW	98%	5.0	3.5	2.0	1.4	50%	46%	7.5%	56%
Chroma	2360 TT	2,070	3,160	26,427	OW	160%	49.4	29.8	22.1	16.3	50%	63%	0.9%	53%
Advantest	6857 JP	34,500	41,000	152,891	OW	113%	43.5	35.5	22.9	17.5	61%	56%	0.3%	19%
Tokyo Electron	8035 JP	55,150	85,000	160,655	OW	42%	33.2	24.5	8.0	6.9	35%	40%	1.5%	54%

Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P., J.P. Morgan estimates. Note: Share prices are as of 24 August 2026

Please see our detailed takeaway notes on specific companies:

[ASE Technology Holding Co Ltd: Key Takeaways from J.P. Morgan Asia Tech Tour](#)

[Hon Hai Precision: Key Takeaways from the J.P. Morgan Asia Tech Tour](#)

[ASPEED Technology Inc.: Key Takeaways from the J.P. Morgan Asia Tech Tour](#)

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[Global Silicon Wafer Sector: Key takeaways from the JPM Asia Tech Tour](#)

[Asia Technology Key Takeaways from J.P. Morgan Asia Tech Tour \(Seoul Part\): Memory Semiconductors](#)

Companies Discussed in This Report (all prices in this report as of market close on 24 August 2026, unless otherwise indicated) ASMPT Ltd (0522)(0522.HK/HK\$157.80/OW), ASUSTek Computer(2357.TW/NT\$923.00/N), Alchip Technologies(3661.TW/NT\$3,735.00/OW), Compal Electronics, Inc.(2324.TW/NT\$41.60/N), GUC(3443.TW/NT\$5,365.00/OW), Grand Process Technology(3131.TW/NT\$2,335.00/OW), Hon Hai Precision(2317.TW/NT\$243.50/OW), Lenovo Group Limited (0992)(0992.HK/HK\$29.64/OW), MediaTek Inc.(2454.TW/NT\$3,765.00/OW), Micro-Star International Co., Ltd.(2377.TW/NT\$144.00/N), Tripod Technology Corp(3044.TW/NT\$450.00/OW), Wistron Corporation(3231.TW/NT\$175.50/OW)

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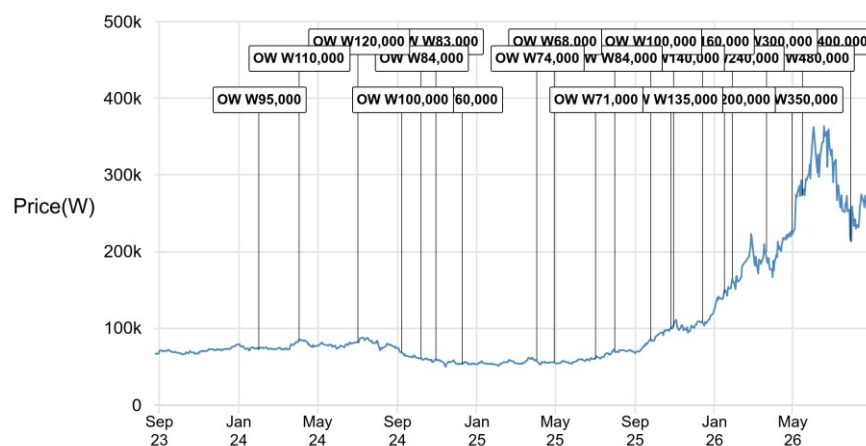
Advantest (6857) (6857.T, 6857 JP) Price Chart



Date	Rating	Price (Y)	Price Target (Y)
27-Sep-23	N	4032	4,375
09-Feb-24	OW	6577	7,400
09-Jul-24	OW	6625	7,700
18-Oct-24	OW	8002	9,200
11-Dec-24	OW	8478	10,500
13-Jun-25	OW	8303	11,000
12-Sep-25	OW	13700	16,000
21-Jan-26	OW	21485	26,000
17-Mar-26	OW	24140	31,000
16-Jun-26	OW	29420	41,000

Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.
Initiated coverage Apr 26, 2001. All share prices are as of market close on the previous business day.

Samsung Electronics (005930.KS, 005930 KS) Price Chart



Date	Rating	Price (W)	Price Target (W)
01-Feb-24	OW	72700	95,000
03-Apr-24	OW	85000	110,000
03-Jul-24	OW	81800	120,000
08-Sep-24	OW	68900	100,000
08-Oct-24	OW	61000	84,000
31-Oct-24	OW	59100	83,000
10-Dec-24	N	53400	60,000
03-Apr-25	OW	58800	74,000
30-Apr-25	OW	55800	68,000
02-Jul-25	OW	60200	71,000
01-Aug-25	OW	71400	84,000
25-Sep-25	OW	85400	100,000
27-Oct-25	OW	98900	135,000
30-Oct-25	OW	101700	140,000
14-Dec-25	OW	108500	160,000
16-Jan-26	OW	145000	200,000
29-Jan-26	OW	164300	240,000
22-Mar-26	OW	199800	300,000
30-Apr-26	OW	226500	350,000
17-May-26	OW	273500	480,000
30-Jul-26	OW	214000	400,000

Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.
Initiated coverage Oct 09, 2011. All share prices are as of market close on the previous business day.

Tokyo Electron (8035) (8035.T, 8035 JP) Price Chart



Date	Rating	Price (Y)	Price Target (Y)
27-Sep-23	OW	20165	24,000
09-Feb-24	OW	29435	34,200
09-Jul-24	OW	36040	41,000
11-Dec-24	OW	24600	35,000
13-Jun-25	OW	25000	31,000
12-Sep-25	OW	21405	26,000
08-Nov-25	OW	32800	38,000
10-Jan-26	OW	37910	45,000
13-Mar-26	OW	39750	51,000
17-Jun-26	OW	70860	85,000

Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.
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